Miss Spider's Wedding

By David Kirk

"Good morning, Miss! A lovely day."
Miss Spider spun around
To see Ike hanging by his knees
Three inches from the ground.

"My good friend Holley," Ike went on,
"Is someone you should know.
But he's too timid to come down
Or even say hello."

They heard a snap and then a crash
And gasped as Holley tumbled.
He flopped down at Miss Spider's feet,
Embarrassed, stunned and rumpled.

Miss Spider knelt to help him up.
He blushed, to shy to speak.
She bid demurely, "Won't you come
To tea one day this week?"

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The color drained from Holley's face.
He looked as though he'd swoon.
His acorn hat slipped from his head.
He gulped, "This afternoon?"

And when she heard his little voice,
It seemed to her somehow
That she had known him always
Though they'd never met 'til now…

INTRODUCTION

Miss Spider is spinning with joy! She has met a wonderful spider man who is wise and kind and ever so sincere. Perhaps he's just the one to be Miss Spider's Mr. Right. But when her well-meaning friends set out to find her a more dashing mate, the suave arachnid strongman they choose threatens to destroy even the best-spun spider plans

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"Please pay attention when I speak.
Stop daydreaming!" barked May.
Miss Spider's thoughts were still upon
The man she met that day.

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May nagged, “You should get on with life.
I thought by now you’d be a wife!”
“But I _” Miss Spider tried to say.
“You mustn’t interrupt!” sniffed May.

May jabbered on and on and on….
Miss Spider, with her patience gone,
Surveyed the clock and tapped the floor,
But when a face peeked ‘round the door,

She whispered, “I apologize,
But, May I just now realize,
A gentleman who asked to call
Is waiting for me in the hall.”

“A man?” squealed May, “Well, Finally!”
She dashed right out so she could see,
The screamed, “Get lost you puny pest.
She’s waiting for her special guest!”

Miss Spider scurried toward the din.
She took his hand, then led him in.
May cried, “How can I stop her folly?

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She’s desperate if she’s dating Holley!”

They talked of all her dreams and hopes,
Of art and nature, love and fate.
They peered though toy kaleidoscopes
And murmured thoughts I shan’t relate.

Then Holley held Miss Spider’s hand….
I’ll say no more, you understand.
For private moments between spiders
Should not be witnessed by outsiders.

Back home, May snipped at Ike, her mate,
“Miss Spider’s come undone!
That milksop Holley is her date.
Go fetch a better one!”

“Be certain he’s intelligent,
Strong, handsome, brave and elegant.
Just find an eight-legged Mr. Right
And bring him back here by tonight.”

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Ike said, “But I think Holley
Is particularly nice.
It’s not just me who thinks so.
You can go and ask the mice.

“They say he’s helpful, wise and kind
And always so polite.
Perhaps he’s just the one to be
Miss Spider’s Mr. Right.”

May gasped, “You’ve lost your senses too!
That pantywaist will never do.
What a difference if he’s kind and wise?
He isn’t half Miss Spider’s size.

“I see I’ll have to go with you.
For clearly, Ike,
You simply do not have a clue
To what we women like.”

May called, “Oh, spider sir, yoo-hoo!
I’ve got the perfect girl for you.”
She whispered, “Now I’ll put things right.”

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“I hope,” squeaked Ike, “he doesn’t bite.”

“Please tell me of this lonely miss,”
The spider strongman cooed.
“Is she a beauty? Is she rich?
And is she in the mood…

“To be adroitly charmed and wooed
By dashing, handsome me?
But, how could it be otherwise!”
He laughed triumphantly.

Miss Spider later welcomed in
This strange arachnid gentleman.
His air was fine, his manner grand.
He bowed and kissed her dainty hand,

“I’ve journeyed her, dear lady,
From the Land of Falling Leaves.
Please let me introduce myself,
I’m called Spiderus Reeves.”

He peered around the drawing room

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At all the finery.
He coveted the furnishings,
The carpets and settee.

All this, he thought, would soon be mine
If she and I were wed.
He mused, her house will suit me well.
But here is what he said:

"My darling, I can plainly see
That you are everything to me.
I long to know the soul within
Your lovely exoskeleton."

"Is it mere chance? No, it is fate,
That soon we shall co-webitate/
'Twas set down by a will divine
That I am yours and you are mine."

"My angel let us not delay,"
The sly Spiderus pled.
"Tomorrow is the perfect day
For you and I to wed."

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"Kind sir, you move to fast for me,"
Miss Spider cried protestingly.
"My love already has been spun
And promised to another one."

"You cannot mean," Spiderus howled,
"That you're rejecting me!
Tell me this loathsome rival's name;
I'll squash him like a flea!"

His hot breath sprayed Miss Spider's face-
With all the force he had,
He screamed, "You will reveal his name!"
She said, "I won't you cad!"

He turned his back and brayed, "I must
Go find and grind him into dust!
So foolish woman, be forewarned.
Spiderus Reeves shall not be scorned."

At that same moment in the hall,
Poor Holley, staring at the wall,

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Could dwell on one and just one thought,
Does she love me? Does she not?

Just then there was a little sound
That didn't seem quite right.
He cocked his head and heard two voices
Whimpering in fright.

"And so it's you," Spiderus snarled,
"Who dares to interfere.
There's been just one mistake, my friend,
But I shall fix it here."

Holley's life flashed before his eyes
Peering up that toothy jaw.
As everything was growing dim,
Fading out, he thought he saw

An angel swoop down in a gown
Of yellow flecked with black,
Who shrieked, "Let go of him, you brute!"
And smacked the scoundrel's back.

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Drifting back to consciousness,
Holley sensed someone he knew….
Yes, yes, Miss Spider's lovely face
Came swimming into view.

"Darling, are you back with me?"
His spider nurse begged hopefully.
"I've tried a hundred different ways
To wake you up for three whole days!"

He gazed upon here reverently,
Then wobbling to her side,
Looked up into her eyes and whispered,
"Will you be my bride?"

A blush of scarlet tinged her cheek.
Her lips, aquiver, could not speak.
He stroked her gently with his feet.
She murmured softly, "Yes, my sweet."

They sat together in the sun,
And when the day is through,
They'd made a list of all the most

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Important things to do.

The crickets would be asked to play
The music on their wedding day.
The field mice, woolly bears and bees
Would cater and affair to please!

"I'll bake the cake," Miss Spider said,
"And weave my silken veils."
The Holley peeped. "I'll spin a suit
With silk to hat and tails!"

"We'll send an incitation out
To every bug alive,
With notices in every bush
And treetop, hill and hive."

"Oh, see how handsome Holley looks!"
Miss spider sings with glee.
"Of all the spiders in the world,
he chose to be with me."

"We've found the place where love abides,

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and share the warmth that it provides
For all those who have found the way
To savor life's most sweet bouquet."

The bride and groom, at last withdrawn
From all the chaos on the lawn,
Poise low upon a willow tree
And hold each other tenderly.

We see their forms in silhouette,
Their shapes are clear to us, and yet,
How can we fully recognize
The beauty seen through true loves eyes.

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